

Imbalance Tracker

Indicators & Analysis / Order Flow & Auction | intermediate | 4 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

The Imbalance Tracker is an advanced market analysis tool that identifies and monitors imbalances between buy and sell orders — places where one side of the market traded far more aggressively than the other. When several imbalances stack on consecutive price levels, the indicator marks the area as a zone on your chart and keeps tracking it until price returns.

It is primarily used in order-flow trading: the zones it draws are the same stacked imbalances you would find manually on a footprint chart, detected and managed for you automatically.

What it is

At each price level the indicator compares aggressive buying against aggressive selling. When the difference exceeds your percentage and volume thresholds — and enough consecutive levels agree — it plots an imbalance zone. Zones come in two states: **Fresh Zone** (price has not yet come back to test the area) and **Triggered Zone** (price has crossed back into it).

When to use it

- To find stacked-imbalance support and resistance without reading every footprint bar by hand.
- To monitor which imbalance zones are still untested (fresh) and which have already been revisited.
- To get an alert the moment a new significant imbalance area forms.
- To add order-flow context to a standard candlestick chart without switching chart types.

Quick start

1. Add **Imbalance Tracker** to your chart.
2. In the imbalance settings, review **Minimum Imbalance %** and **Minimum Volume Diff** — these two filters decide how significant a difference must be before it counts.
3. Set **Min. Num. Of Consecutive Imb** to require stacked imbalances rather than isolated ones; higher values produce fewer, stronger zones.
4. In the plot settings, pick distinct **Buy Color** and **Sell Color** values so buy-side and sell-side zones are unmistakable.
5. Optionally enable alerts so new zones notify you with a sound and popup.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A candlestick chart with the Imbalance Tracker active, showing a fresh buy-side imbalance zone extending right from a bullish impulse and a faded triggered zone above it

imbalance-tracker-zones-chart.png

How to read it

A buy-side zone marks levels where aggressive buyers overwhelmed sellers; in order-flow logic those levels often act as support on a retest, because the participants who bought there may defend the area. Sell-side zones are the mirror image and often act as resistance.

The zone state carries information too. A **Fresh Zone** is untested — the market has not yet returned to check whether the aggressive side will defend it. Once price crosses into the area it becomes a **Triggered Zone** and is recolored, telling you the level has already been consumed at least once. With **Trigger Only Touch** enabled, the triggered display is limited to zones price has retested at least once.

For the underlying theory of aggressive buyers, sellers and delta, see Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta; for how imbalances look inside individual bars, see Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples — or explore it directly below by adjusting the diagonal-imbalance ratio and watching which bid×ask pairs light up:

[WIDGET: footprint-lab]

Settings reference

Imbalance Settings

Setting	What it does
Minimum Imbalance %	The minimum percentage difference between buy and sell orders for a level to qualify — the significance filter.
Minimum Volume Diff	The volume threshold that must be exceeded before an imbalance is detected. Raise it on active instruments to ignore trivial differences.
Include zero on imbalance	Whether ticks with zero volume on one side are included in the imbalance calculation.
Min. Num. Of Consecutive Imb	How many consecutive imbalanced price levels are required before the indicator marks an area.

Plot Settings

Setting	What it does
Num. Extended Bars	How many bars forward a zone is drawn across the chart.
Line Width	Thickness of the zone highlight lines.
Fresh Zone	Displays imbalance areas that price has not retested, with separate Buy Color and Sell Color options.
Triggered Zone	Shows zones price has crossed, with Enable , Trigger Only Touch , Buy Trig Color and Sell Trig Color options.

Alert Settings

Setting	What it does
Enable	Activates sound and popup notifications when a signal is generated.
Alert-Name	Selects which notification sound plays.
Popup-message	Customizes the text shown in the popup.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Imbalance Tracker settings dialog showing the Imbalance Settings group with Minimum Imbalance %, Minimum Volume Diff, Include zero on imbalance and Min. Num. Of Consecutive Imb

imbalance-tracker-settings-dialog.png

Tips and common mistakes

- **Too low a consecutive count means noise.** A single imbalanced level is common; requiring several consecutive levels is what makes a zone meaningful.
- **Tune volume thresholds per instrument.** A **Minimum Volume Diff** that works on a liquid index future will flag everything on a thin contract — and vice versa.
- **Think about zero prints.** **Include zero on imbalance** changes what counts as an imbalance at levels where one side traded nothing at all; test both settings against your market.
- **Watch zone state, not only zone location.** A level that has already been triggered repeatedly is not the same trade as a fresh, untested zone.
- **Keep the chart readable.** Large **Num. Extended Bars** values leave many old zones on screen; shorten the extension if the chart becomes cluttered.

Related articles

- [Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta](#)
- [Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples](#)
- [Imbalance Rejector](#)
- [Deep Print \(Footprint\)](#)
- [Different Types of Input Data for Indicators](#)
- [How to Change the Layout of Indicators](#)